



INDIVIDUAL QUESTIONS – INTRODUCTION

CHAPTER CONTENTS.

Because the output is a structured network, we can apply a range of queries to explore the data. This gives us a library of **pre-existing approaches** to ask **practical questions** about the causal landscape described by the participants.

Here's a poster showing a few of the main questions.

See also

- [Formatting your map for what you want to show](#) for the visualisation side.
- [Vignettes](#) for textual outputs.

PAGES IN THIS CHAPTER

 **Individual views – How does the system work according to individual sources ?**

 **Summarising – How do the sources claim that the system works, in summary ?**

 **Vignettes – What is a typical source and what is their story ?**

 **What are the narratives behind a specific link ?**

 **Which factors and links were most frequently mentioned ?**

 **Which factors and links are mentioned by the most sources ?**

 **Main outcomes. Which factors are mentioned most often as outcomes ?**

 **Main drivers. Which factors are mentioned most often as drivers ?**

 **Splitting by groups. Are different groups involved in different ways ?**

 **Comparing groups – What factors or links were mentioned more by some groups than others, in the same map ?**

 **Identifying groups – Are there different subgroups within the data ?**

 **What are the emerging or unexpected factors ?**

 **Does the evidence support your theory of change ?**

 **Assessing systems change**

 **Sentiment – Which changes are perceived as most positive or negative ?**

 **Sentiment discrepancy – Which factors do sources most disagree about ?**

-  **Focusing on specific factors. What influences and outcomes are connected to a specific factor ?**
-  **Looking downstream. What are the direct and indirect consequences of one or more factors ?**
-  **Looking upstream. What are the direct and indirect influences on one or more factors ?**
-  **Path tracing – How do one or more causes affect one or more effects, including indirect pathways ?**
-  **Source tracing – What are the consequences of one or more factors, looking only at stories told in their entirety by individual sources ?**
-  **Robustness – How robust is the evidence for that X influences Y ?**
-  **Counting and comparing influences**
-  **Properties of the causal map – Which factors are reported as being causally central or causally peripheral ?**
-  **Properties of the causal map – What is the overall structure of the network ?**
-  **Properties of the causal map – Are there leverage points ?**
-  **Properties of the causal map – Are there feedback loops ?**
-  **Combining questions**
-  **Tribes. The most relevantly different subgroups in your data (by causal story)**
-  **Showing group data as custom link labels on the map with optional significance test**
-  **Names of tables and fields**
-  **Hierarchical coding**